

The Folded Horizon

Site Analysis

Coordinates: 25.2279165° N, 91.7317844° E

Longitude: 91.7317844° E

Latitude: 25.2279165° N

Region: Sohra (Cherrapunji), East Khasi Hills, Meghalaya

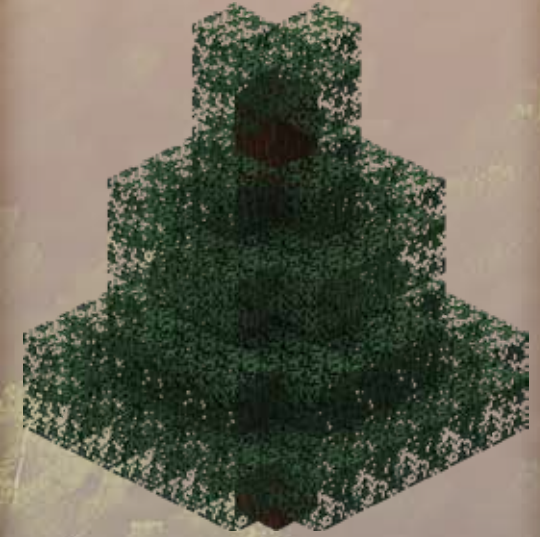
Approx. elevation shown in Google Earth: 1,106 m above MSL

Regional setting: Southern edge of the Meghalaya / Shillong Plateau.

The site is located in Sohra (Cherrapunji), Meghalaya, at approximately 25.2279° N, 91.7318° E, at an elevation of around 1,106 m above sea level. It is an elongated open parcel surrounded by dense vegetation and connected to the local road network, giving it a strong relationship with the natural landscape.

The site is primarily influenced by Sohra's extreme monsoon climate, high rainfall, and plateau topography. Receiving over 11,000 mm of rainfall annually, effective drainage, rainwater harvesting, generous roof overhangs, and protection from wind-driven rain are critical design considerations. The relatively cool and humid climate also encourages the use of natural ventilation and moisture-resistant materials.

The surrounding forest, minimal built development, and potential views toward the valleys create opportunities for a landscape-integrated and view-oriented design. The existing vegetation should be retained as much as possible to reduce erosion, manage runoff, and preserve the ecological character of the site. Overall, the design should respond to the site's rain, terrain, vegetation, and views through contour-sensitive planning, minimal earthwork, and a strong integration between architecture and the natural environment.



Indian Rubber Fig



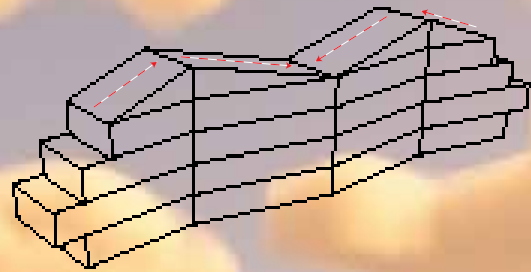
Sacred Tree



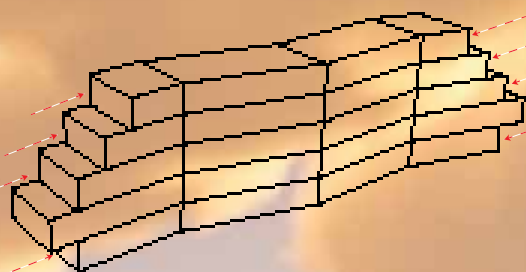
Sal Tree

The Folded Horizon

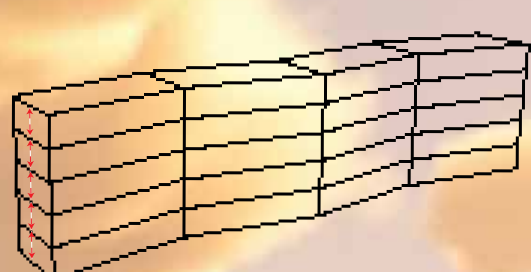
Conceptual Designing



The roof planes are dynamically pitched up and down at key vertices to form a faceted, mountainous top profile.



The individual floor plates slide horizontally along the main axis in alternating directions to create staggered overhangs and terraces.



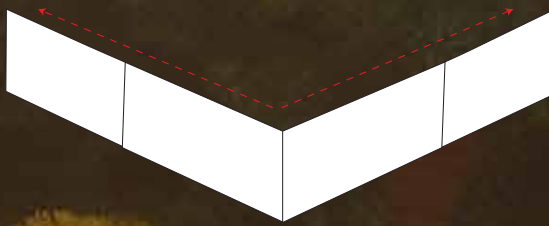
The structure is divided horizontally into stacked floor plates via vertical extrusion or layering.



A simple, undulating extruded volume establishes the initial horizontal footprint and massing.

A basic, continuous rectangular footprint establishes the initial linear boundary adhering to the site boundary

The linear footprint is segmented into four equal zones using perpendicular dashed grid lines.



The segmented plan is folded at its central axis, stretching outward to form a V-shaped configuration.



The outer segments are folded back outward to complete a dynamic, zigzagging serpentine layout.

Folded Horizon is a Minecraft-inspired residential retreat for a solitary novelist, situated within the lush mountainous landscape of Sohra (Cherrapunji), Meghalaya. The design responds to the natural terrain through a linear, stepped form that follows the contours of the site, allowing the residence to blend into the surrounding forest rather than dominate it. The project translates Minecraft's block-based language into architecture through cubic masses, stepped terrain, stone walls, timber surfaces, glass openings, green roofs, and modular landscape elements. The building and landscape are designed as a continuous composition, creating the impression of a block-built dwelling emerging from the mountain. Designed around privacy, creativity, and contemplation, the residence uses large glazed openings, terraced gardens, stepped pathways, and a reflective pond to establish a strong connection between the interior and landscape. The combination of natural materials and pixelated forms creates a contrast between the organic forest and the structured geometry of the building.

The extreme rainfall of Sohra is incorporated through sloping roofs, planted terraces, water collection, and integrated drainage, allowing rain to become part of the spatial experience. Ultimately, Folded Horizon explores the intersection of digital architecture, natural landscape, and inhabitation, creating a secluded creative retreat where the building, terrain, and Minecraft-inspired world become one continuous environment.



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Front Elevation